

CHEYNEY UNIVERSITY · INSPIREDBI



The Wolfpack's Guide to AI

What is AI? The inner workings, in plain language.

The five building blocks

1. **Generative AI** — creates net-new content
2. **Large Language Models** — predict the next word
3. **Multimodal models** — text, image, audio, video at once
4. **RAG** — grounds AI in your trusted knowledge
5. **Agentic AI** — plans and completes multi-step tasks

CONCEPT 1

Generative AI (GenAI)

Creates net-new content

Produces brand-new text, code, images, audio, or video from a prompt — content that never existed before.

Plain version: a sophisticated remix of the patterns it learned from human-made examples.

CONCEPT 2

Large Language Models (LLMs)

The engine behind text AI

Predicts the next word (token) over and over to build fluent, useful answers.

Plain version: the world's most sophisticated autocomplete.

CONCEPT 3

Large Multimodal Models (LMMs)

Sees, hears, and reads at once

Understands and creates across text, images, audio, and video in a single conversation.

Plain version: if an LLM reads, an LMM reads and looks and listens.

CONCEPT 4

Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)

Grounds AI in your trusted knowledge

Looks up real, approved information first, then answers from it
— far fewer hallucinations.

Plain version: open-book instead of from-memory.

CONCEPT 5

Agentic AI (AI Agents)

From answering to doing

Give it a goal; it plans the steps, uses tools, and works through a multi-step task to a finish.

Plain version: an assistant who actually carries out the plan, step by step.

Putting it to work

For Staff

- Protect data privacy — approved tools only
- Redesign syllabi for AI, assignment by assignment
- Evaluate bias: who is missing? whose view dominates?
- Treat AI as a co-creator, not an oracle

Working with Students

- Cultivate a growth mindset
- Teach verification of AI output
- Use AI for executive-function coaching
- Build self-regulated learning

Keep learning

Full guide, all five videos, and staff & student resources:

inspiredbi.org/what-is-ai.html